

Shlipada



Learning Objectives

- ⇒ To understand the concept of Shlipada
- ⇒ To understand the Nidana, Panchaka Samprapti of Shlipada mentioned in Ayurveda literatures
- ⇒ To frame out the probable Samprapti Ghataka based on the progression of the disease
- ⇒ To learn about filariasis and elephantiasis in brief

Introduction

त्रीण्यप्येतानि जानीयात् श्लीपदानि कफोच्छ्रयात्।

गुरुत्वं च महत्त्वं च यस्मान्नास्ति कफं विना॥५॥

Ma.Ni. – 39/5

This is a disease involving *Kapha Dosha* dominance and is associated with large swelling and heaviness of the **lower limb**¹ in all three types of *Shlipada*. In this disease, the nature of the swelling simulates the texture of stone. In western medicine, while describing the above terminology, filariasis and elephantiasis are used. **Filariasis** (see Figure 244) is the term used when the person is having lymphatic obstruction due to live adult worm present in the lymphatics and non pitting oedema is observed during the examination. **Elephantiasis**² (see Figure 245) is the term used when there is enormous thickening of the scrotal skin resembling elephant's hide leading to enlargement of scrotum.

In this disease, the individual will have non pitting type of oedema as the pathogenic organism resides in the

interstitial spaces occluding the path of lymphatic system.

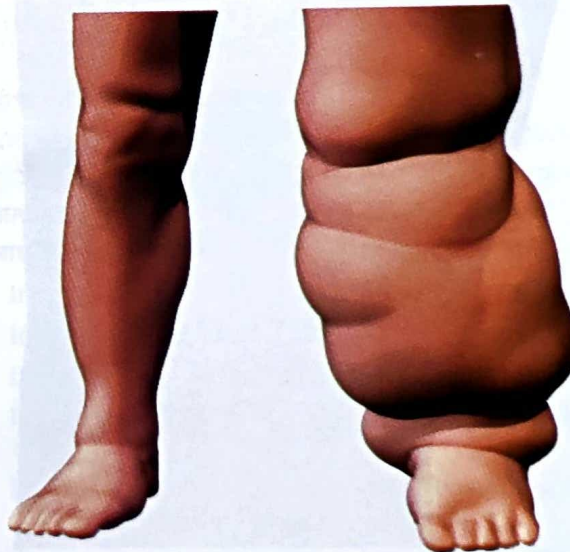


Figure 244: Pratyatma Lakshana of Shlipada

¹ In the context of western medicine, swelling (oedema) can occur because of following reasons.

1. Increased hydrostatic pressure in the capillaries
 2. Decreased oncotic pressure in the capillaries
 3. Damage to the capillary wall
 4. Lymphatic obstruction
 5. Increased sodium and water retention
 - Increased hydrostatic pressure in the capillaries or decreased oncotic pressure and increased sodium and water retention is responsible for pitting type of oedema.
 - Lymphatic obstruction can lead to non pitting type of oedema. This is the main reason for the hard to stony hard appearance of the swelling.
 - Damage to the capillary wall will lead to inflammatory type of oedema.
- ² The most common cause of elephantiasis is *Wuchereria bancrofti*. The main vector responsible for the spread of this infection is *Culex mosquito*. The patients may remain asymptomatic or may manifest with fever, local pain, swelling, rash, tender lymph nodes and eosinophilia. Due to the eosinophilia, an individual may develop asthma like presentation in some cases.

Derivation of Shlipada

शिलावत् पदं श्लीपदम्॥

मधु, मा.नि. - 39/2

शनैः शनैर्धनं शोफं श्लीपदं तत् प्रचक्षते॥

अ.स.उ. 34/19

This is a pathological condition in which the foot becomes swollen and hardened like a stone. This is a slowly progressive clinical condition. That is why this condition is known as *Shlipada*.

पारियात्रभवा याश्च विन्ध्यसह्यभवाश्च याः।

शिरोहृद्रोगकुष्ठानां ता हेतुः श्लीपदस्य च॥212॥

Ca.Su. - 27/212

Nidana of Shlipada

पुराणोदकभूयिष्ठाः सर्वतुषु च शीतलाः।

यै देशास्तेषु जायन्ते श्लीपदानि विशेषतः॥6॥

Ma.Ni. - 39/6

The disease is commonly seen in the places having **stagnant water**³ for longer time and in the places where the environment is colder in most of the times.



Figure 245: Kharatva of Tvak in Shlipada

Samprapti of Shlipada

जङ्घासु पिण्डीप्रपैदोपरिष्ठात् स्याच्छ्लीपदं मांसकफास्त्रदोषात्।

Ca.Ci. - 12/98

कुपितास्तु दोषाः वातपित्तश्लेष्माणोऽधः प्रपन्ना वङ्गणोरुजानुजङ्घाखवतिष्ठ मानाः कालान्तरेण पादमाश्रित्य शनैः शोकं उपजनयन्ति तत् श्लीपदमित्याचक्षते।

तत् त्रिविधं वातपित्तकफनिमित्तमिति

Su.Ni. - 12/10

प्रस्थिता वणोर्वादिमधः कार्यं कफोल्बणाः॥18॥

दोषा मांसास्त्रगाः पादौ कालेनाश्रित्य कुर्वते।

शनैः शनैर्धनं शोफं श्लीपदं तत्प्रचक्षते॥19॥

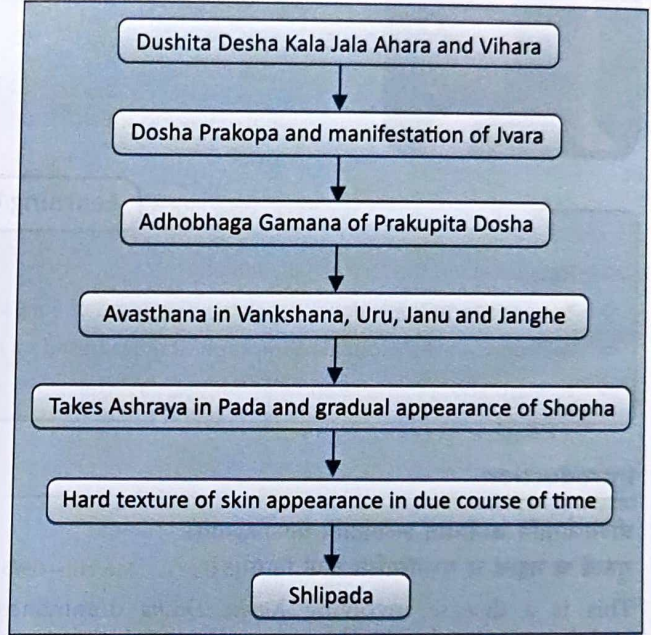
A.Hr.Ut. - 29/18-19

शिश्नौष्ठनासास्वपि केचिदाहुः॥

ग्रीवावक्षणाजङ्घौष्ठपादकर्णकराश्रयम्।

श्लीपदं मांसमेदोभ्यां विद्यात्॥

पुष्कलावत, चक्र, च.चि. - 12/98



Samprapti Ghataka

- Dosha : Kapha
- Dushya : Rasa, Rakta
- Srotas : Rasavaha, Raktavaha
- Dushti Prakara : Sanga and Vimargagamana
- Udbhava Sthana : Amashaya
- Sanchara Sthana : Sarva Sharira
- Vyakta Sthana : Adho Shakha
- Agni : Jatharagni Mandya
- Ama : Jatharagnimandya Janya Ama
- Vyadhyavastha : Chirakari
- Rogamarga : Abhyantara and Bahya
- Sadhyasadyata : Asadhya

Purvarupa of Shlipada

वङ्गणावस्थानमेवास्य पूर्वरूपम्।

Madhu, Ma.Ni. - 39/2,3

The swelling observed in the region of **Vamkshana**⁴ (groin)

G
K

- 3 When the water is stagnant at a particular space for longer time, it becomes a breeding place for the mosquitoes. Anopheles, Culex and Aedes aegypti are the different varieties of mosquitoes breed in stagnant water. Bite of these mosquitoes will lead to various infectious diseases. Biting of the Culex mosquitoes is responsible for the transmission of filariasis and elephantiasis.
- 4 Swelling in the inguinal region or groin indicates the site of the lesion in lower limb. This sign indicates the lymphatic obstruction occurring in the lower limb. When the person is having chronic lymphatic obstruction, the skin becomes rough like the skin of the elephant, otherwise

is considered as prodromal symptom of *Shlipada*.



Figure 246: Purvarupa of Shlipada

Samanya Lakshana of Shlipada

यः सज्वरो वंक्षणजो भृशार्तिः शोथो नेणां पादगतः क्रमेण।
तच्छ्लीपदं स्यात् करकर्णनेत्रशिशौष्ठनासास्वपि केचिदाहुः॥

Ma.Ni.39/1

The disease initially presented with manifestation of fever and severe cutting type of pain in the inguinal region. This is followed by development of oedema which reaches till the foot. The oedema turns hard in which the consistency or texture appears like stone. Therefore the term *Shlipada*. The swelling can also occur in hands, ears, eyes, genitals, lips and nose in due course of time.

पादयोर्हस्तयोश्चापि श्लीपदं जायते नृणाम्॥

कर्णाक्षिनासिकौष्ठेषु केचिदिच्छन्ति तद्विदः॥1 5॥

Su.Ni. - 12/15

Stony hard swelling observed in the lower limb, upper limb, ears, eyes, nose and lips

Classification of Shlipada

3 types: *Vataja Shlipada*, *Pittaja Shlipada* and *Kaphaja Shlipada*.

1. Vataja Shlipada

the patient may have non pitting type of oedema. As the microorganisms enter the lymphatics, this will be blocked in the lymph nodes to prevent the further entry of the microorganisms into the thoracic duct. Thus, the person may have the swelling of the groin region. When the individual is having duration of illness, i.e. swelling in the lower limb, that will lead to thickness of the skin along with non pitting type. As the size of the swelling is getting bigger, it usually takes more time to have subsidence of the swelling. The bigger the swelling, more incurability of the illness. If the swelling resembles ant hill or skin of the elephant, then it indicates the incurability of the illness owing to lymphatic obstruction. When the person is having Kapha Prakriti and the Dosha responsible for the manifestation of *Shlipada* is also Kapha Dosha. This stage represents the more severity of the illness. As the duration of the illness is longer, there will be the vitiation of Vata Dosha along with Kapha. This is indicative of incurability of the illness when two Dosha vitiation are seen. In Ayurveda, there is a rule if you want to treat any disease, one has to avoid the aetiological factors for the vitiation of that particular Dosha responsible for the manifestation of the disease. *Shlipada* is a Kapha dominant illness. If an individual is continuously consuming the Kapha vitiating factors, then such stage of the illness is considered as *Asadhya* (incurable) in nature. When an individual is presented with profuse amount of discharge from the oedematous swelling indicates severity in the degree of lymphatic obstruction. This feature indicates the shrinkage of interstitial compartment as the movement from the interstitial compartment to the lymphatic channels is blocked due to lymphatic obstruction.

वातजं कृष्ण रूक्षं च स्फुटितं तीव्रवेदनम्।
अनिमित्तरुजं तस्य बहुशो ज्वर एव च॥

मा.नि. - 39/2

Shlipada manifested due to the vitiation of *Vata Dosha* appears black in colour. The surface of the swelling will be dry and rough. There will be appearance of cracks or fissures due to the dryness which leads to the development of severe pain. The timing and intensity of pain and onset of fever may vary and it is uncertain.

2. Pittaja Shlipada

पित्तजं पीतसंकाशं दाहज्वरयुतं मृदु॥

मा.नि. - 39/3

Pittaja Shlipada will be having yellowish discolouration. This is associated with burning sensation and raised body temperature. The swelling or oedema will be softer.

3. Kaphaja Shlipada

श्लैष्मिकं स्निग्धवर्णं च श्वेतं पाण्डु गुरु स्थिरम्॥

मा.नि. - 39/3

Kaphaja Shlipada has slimy or oily surface and yellowish white or pale to white in colour. The size of the swelling will be bigger when compared to other variety of *Shlipada*. But there is no variation or unstability in the size like *Vataja Shlipada*.

Sadhyasadhya

तत्र संवत्सरातीतमतिमहद्वल्मीकजातं प्रसृतमिति वर्जनीयानि॥1 2॥

Su.Ni. - 12/12

वल्मीकमिव संजातं कण्टकैरुपचीयते।

अब्दात्मकं महत्तच्च वर्जनीयं विशेषतः॥4॥

Ma.Ni. - 39/4

यत् श्लेष्मलाहारविहारजातं पुंसः प्रक्त्याऽपि (Prakritya Api) कफात्मकस्य।

सास्त्रावमत्युन्नतसर्वलिङ्गं सकण्डुरं श्लेष्मयुतं विवर्ज्यम्॥ मा.नि. - 39/7

⊗ If the duration of the illness is more than one year⁵

⊗ If the size of the swelling is big in size⁶

⊗ If the nature of the swelling resembles ant hill⁷

⊗ If an individual who is born with *Kapha* dominant *Prakriti*⁸

⊗ If an individual is continuously consuming food substances which provoke *Kapha Dosha*⁹

⊗ Profuse discharge from the oedematous swelling¹⁰

Key summary of the chapter

शिलावत् पदं श्लीपदम्॥

शनैः शनैर्घनं शोफं श्लीपदं तत् प्रचक्षते॥

मधु, मा.नि. - 39/2

अ.स.उ. 34/19

This is a pathological condition in which the foot becomes swollen and hardened like a stone. This is a slowly progressive clinical condition. That is why this condition is known as Shlipada.

- Leading a lifestyle around environment where stagnant water is commonly observed. This is also seen in conditions, where frequent exposure to cold environment is observed.

वङ्क्षणावस्थानमेवास्य पूर्वरूपम्।

Madhu, Ma.Ni. - 39/2,3 A swelling in the groin or inguinal region is the Purvarupa mentioned in texts.

- 3 types of Shlipada are mentioned in Ayurveda literatures. Vataja, Pittaja and Kaphaja varieties of Shlipada.
- When the individual is having the continuous exposure to Kapha vitiating factors, if the person is of Kaphaja Prakriti, if the duration of the illness is more than one year, if the swelling of the lower limb is larger and when the person is having profuse discharge through the oedematous limb are features seen in incurable *Shlipada* disease.

Self-Assessment: Questions for Reviews

Short essays

- Define Shlipada and explain the types
- Define the Nidana Panchaka of Shlipada
- Describe Asadhya Lakshana of Shlipada.

Short answers

- Define Shlipada
- Enumerate Types of Shlipada
- Write a brief note of Vataja Shlipada
- Explain in brief about the Nidana of Shlipada.

MCQs

- Dosha dominance observed in the patient of Shlipada is
 - Kapha;
 - Pitta;
 - Vata;
 - Rakta

Answer: (a)

- To which type of Prakriti individual, Shlipada is considered to be Asadhya?
 - Kapha;
 - Pitta;
 - Vata;
 - Rakta

Answer: (a)

- As per Madhava Nidana, the duration of Shlipada in case of incurability is
 - 1 month;
 - 1 day;
 - 1 year;
 - 10 years

Answer: (c)

4. Sankhya Samprapti of Shlipada is

- 7 types;
- 3 types;
- 4 types;
- 8 types

Answer: (b)

5. Stony hard swelling in the lower limb is indicative of

- Increased hydrostatic pressure in capillaries;
- Decreased oncotic pressure in the capillaries
- Capillary damage;
- Lymphatic obstruction

Answer: (d)

6. As per Charaka, Shlipada is due to

- Vitiation of Mamsa, Kapha and Rakta;
- Vitiation of Medas, Kapha and Rakta;
- Vitiation of Majja, Kapha and Rakta;
- Vitiation of Vasa, Kapha and Rakta

Answer: (a)

7. As per Madhukosha commentary of Madhava Nidana, Purvarupa of Shlipada is

- Swelling in the Vamkshana region;
- Swelling in Vrishana region;
- Swelling in Pada region;
- Swelling in Vaksha region

Answer: (a)

8. Shilavat Padam Shlipadam is said by

- Indu in Ashtanga Sangraha;
- Srikanthadatta in Madhava Nidana;
- Chakrapani in Charaka Samhita;
- Dalhana in Sushruta Samhita

Answer: (b)

9. Which of the following is considered as the Nidana of Shlipada?

- Ushnodaka;
- Hamsodaka;
- Navodaka;
- Puranodaka

Answer: (d)

10. The vector responsible for the spread of filariasis is

- Female anopheles mosquito;
- Culex mosquito;
- Aedes aegypti mosquito;
- Fly

Answer: (b)

Chapter resources

- ⊗ Madhava Nidana – 39th chapter, Shlipada Nidana
- ⊗ Charaka Samhita, Sutra Sthana, 27th chapter – Annapana Vidhi Adhyaya
- ⊗ Charaka Samhita, Chikitsa Sthana – 12th chapter, Shotha Chikitsa Adhyaya
- ⊗ Sushruta Samhita, Nidana Sthana – 12th chapter, Vriddhi Upadamsha Shlipada Nidana Adhyaya
- ⊗ Ashtanga Sangraha, Uttara Tantra, 34th chapter – Granthi Arbuda Shlipada Apachi Nadi Vijnaniya Adhyaya

- ⊗ Golwalla's medicine for students by Aspi F Golwalla and Sharukh A Golwalla, edited by Milind Y Nadkar, 25th edition, Jaypee Brothers Medical Publishers (P) Ltd, New Delhi, 2017
- ⊗ The Merck Manual of Diagnosis and Therapy by Robert S Porter and Justin L Kaplan, 19th edition, Merck Sharp & Dohme Corp, New Jersey, 2011
- ⊗ Chamberlain's symptoms and signs in clinical medicine by Colin Ogilvie and Christopher C Evans, 12th edition, Butterworth-Heinemann Publishers, 1997
- ⊗ Best & Taylor's physiological basis of medical practice by O P Tandon and Y Tripathi, 13th edition, Wolters Kluwer Health (India) Pvt. Ltd, Gurgaon, 2012
- ⊗ Textbook of Medical physiology by Arthur C Guyton and John E Hall, 11th edition, Saunders Elsevier publications, Philadelphia, 2006
- ⊗ Textbook of pathology by Harsh Mohan, 5th edition, Jaypee Brothers Medical Publishers (P) Ltd, New Delhi, 2005
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